PHASE 1 USER GUIDE

SAQR Installation and Evaluation Guide

A client-facing technical guide for installing and trying the preserved SAQR Phase 1 demo path. This document is intentionally honest: it enables local evaluation, not direct production deployment.

AUDIENCE

Client Technical Review Team

PRIMARY PATH

Demo Evaluation Install

PHASE

Phase 1

DATE

2026-04-07

Use This Document For

Local installation and trial of the preserved demo experience.

Do Not Use This Document For

Production deployment, security hardening, or client cutover.

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

1. Executive Summary

This guide provides a practical way for a client technical team to install and try SAQR Phase 1 locally using the preserved demo environment. It is designed for evaluation, walkthroughs, and limited hands-on testing of the user experience and core platform narrative.

Important Truth
The installation path in this guide is not a production deployment. It is a local evaluation path based on the preserved demo runtime. The production-ready handoff package exists for the delivery team and requires external prerequisites not provided in this repository.

RECOMMENDED OUTCOME

Local Trial

Validate the UI flow, demo runtime, and API heartbeat locally.

TECHNICAL LEVEL

Moderate

Designed for technical reviewers comfortable with terminal commands.

EXPECTED TIME

20-30 Min

Assuming Node.js is already installed.

SCOPE

2. Scope, Audience, and Limitations

2.1 Intended audience

- Client technical reviewers
- Client innovation or digital teams
- Client compliance stakeholders supported by a technical user

2.2 What this guide covers

- Local dependency bootstrap
- Launching the demo-mode API
- Opening the preserved Shield UI
- Verifying first-run success
- Trying core demo interactions safely

TOPIC	INCLUDED IN THIS GUIDE	NOT INCLUDED IN THIS GUIDE
Demo environment	Yes	-
Production-ready delivery handoff	Referenced only	Direct client self-install
Real DB, Kafka, IdP, or VMS integration	No	Handled by delivery team
Production cutover	No	Outside Phase 1 client trial scope

REQUIREMENTS

3. System Requirements

REQUIREMENT	MINIMUM	RECOMMENDED
Operating system	Windows 10/11, macOS, or Linux	Windows 11 or recent macOS / Linux
Node.js	Version 22	Latest 22.x LTS-compatible release
npm	Installed with Node.js	Latest version bundled with Node.js 22
Browser	Chrome, Edge, or Firefox	Latest Chrome or Edge
Disk space	3 GB free	5 GB free
Internet access	Needed for npm package install	Needed for a smoother first-time setup
Optional utility	Python 3 for local static hosting	Python 3 installed and available on PATH

Free-Tool Rule

The steps below use only free tools: Node.js, npm, a web browser, and optionally Python for local static file serving.

PACKAGE CONTENTS

4. Package Contents

LOCATION	WHY IT MATTERS FOR INSTALLATION
`apps/shield-ui`	Contains the Gateway Selector and Shield Dashboard UI.
`apps/api`	Contains the API service used for local heartbeat validation.
`.env.demo.example`	Contains the demo runtime configuration values used in this guide.
`tools/ci/bootstrap-workspace.js`	Used by `npm run phase1:bootstrap` to install dependencies.
`docs/handoff/*`	Delivery-team package. Useful for technical reference, but not needed for basic client trial.

DECISION GUIDE

5. Installation Decision Guide

IF YOU WANT TO...	USE THIS PATH	RECOMMENDED?
See the preserved SAQR experience quickly and safely	Demo evaluation install in this guide	Yes
Validate production-ready infrastructure wiring	Delivery-team handoff package	Delivery only
Go live in a client environment	Not covered by this guide	No

INSTALLATION STEPS

6. Step-by-Step Demo Evaluation Install

Step 1. Obtain the repository package

Place the SAQR repository on your machine by either:

- cloning it from GitHub, or
- extracting the provided ZIP into a local working folder.

```
git clone https://github.com/aboutony/SAQR.git
cd SAQR
```

Step 2. Open a terminal in the repository root

The repository root is the folder that contains `package.json`, `apps`, `services`, `docs`, and `infra`.

Step 3. Install all required dependencies

Run the Phase 1 bootstrap command from the repository root:

```
npm run phase1:bootstrap
```

Expected success signal: `[phase1:bootstrap] workspace bootstrap complete`

Step 4. Start the SAQR demo API

Open a dedicated terminal window and use the following PowerShell commands. These commands load the demo configuration into the current process and start the API in demo mode.

```
Get-Content .env.demo.example | Where-Object { $_ -and $_ -
notmatch '^\s*#' } | ForEach-Object {
    $name, $value = $_ -split '=', 2
    [System.Environment]::SetEnvironmentVariable($name, $value,
'Process')
```

```
}

Set-Location apps\api
npm start
```

Keep this terminal window open while you are evaluating SAQR.

Step 5. Verify the API heartbeat

In a browser, open the following URL:

```
http://127.0.0.1:3001/api/v1/sources/heartbeat
```

You should receive a JSON response with demo runtime status and the demo authority list.

Step 6. Launch the Shield UI

The fastest path is to open the Gateway Selector directly in your browser:

```
apps\shield-ui\GatewaySelector.html
```

If your browser or security policy does not allow local HTML execution comfortably, use a simple local static server from the `apps/shield-ui` folder:

```
cd apps\shield-ui
python -m http.server 8080
```

Then open:

```
http://127.0.0.1:8080/GatewaySelector.html
```

FIRST RUN

7. First-Run Validation

CHECKPOINT	WHAT SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE
Bootstrap complete	The install command completes without dependency errors.
API heartbeat	The heartbeat URL returns JSON with `"runtimeMode":"demo"`.
Gateway Selector opens	The initial SAQR gateway page renders in your browser.
Dashboard opens	After session setup, the Shield dashboard loads without a fatal error page.
Demo behavior appears	You can see demo metrics, demo stream behavior, and preserved controls.

Validated In This Repository

The local demo API startup and heartbeat path were verified from this repository state while preparing this guide.

TRY SAQR

8. How To Try SAQR

8.1 Initialize a session

1. Open the Gateway Selector page.
2. Enter a corporate email and organization ID.
3. Select a market, industry, and language.
4. Enter the dashboard.

8.2 Suggested evaluation path

- Review the top-level dashboard metrics and authority heartbeat.
- Inspect the Meta-Audit Stream table and the Instruction Drift panel.
- Try the preserved demo controls if they are visible in the demo runtime.
- Observe how the session changes based on market and industry selection.

WHAT YOU MAY SEE	WHY IT APPEARS
Demo metrics and populated cards	The demo runtime intentionally preserves embedded data and simulation flows.
Authority heartbeat data	The demo API exposes a local heartbeat endpoint on port 3001.
Read-only posture badges	SAQR is intentionally designed as a read-only compliance interception product.
No real client data	This guide does not connect any client DB, VMS, or third-party platform.

What This Trial Does Not Prove

A successful local evaluation does not prove production readiness in the client environment. It only proves that the preserved Phase 1 demo path can be installed and tried locally.

8.3 Optional note for advanced technical reviewers

The repository also includes a production-ready handoff package for the delivery team. That path is documented separately and depends on real infrastructure such as shadow PostgreSQL, Kafka, an identity provider, and VMS connectivity. It is not a self-service client install path.

TROUBLESHOOTING

9. Troubleshooting

ISSUE	LIKELY CAUSE	SUGGESTED FIX
`npm run phase1:bootstrap` fails	Node.js or npm is missing, outdated, or blocked by network policy.	Install Node.js 22 and rerun the bootstrap command.
Heartbeat URL does not respond	The API terminal is not running or port 3001 is in use.	Restart the API terminal and confirm nothing else is bound to port 3001.
UI opens but looks incomplete	Local file restrictions or blocked external assets in the browser.	Use the optional Python static server path and reopen the UI through `http://127.0.0.1:8080`.
The dashboard opens but some live calls fail	The demo runtime still attempts heartbeat visibility through the API.	Confirm the API terminal is running and the heartbeat URL returns JSON.
You expected real client integrations	This guide is limited to the preserved demo path.	Escalate to the delivery team and use the delivery handoff package instead.

STOP AND CLEANUP

10. Stop and Cleanup

10.1 Stop the local run

- Close the browser tabs.
- Return to the API terminal window and press `Ctrl + C`.
- If you started a Python static server, stop it with `Ctrl + C` as well.

10.2 Remove the local package if required

If you only needed a temporary evaluation copy, delete the extracted or cloned SAQR folder after the trial is complete.

Escalation Path

If the client wishes to move beyond this local evaluation and into delivery-led implementation, the correct next artifact is the delivery handoff package in `docs/handoff/README.md`.

End of document.